

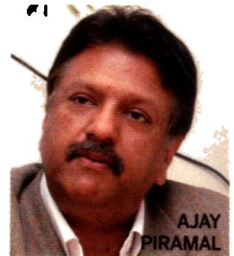
10

business break-ups

Bad blood over inheritance of family fortunes has never gone out of circulation, whether it was the mother of all battles between the brothers Ambani or the question of who laid better claim to Hamara Bajaj. Here are 10 of the big, bad battles.

2 Separation Pangs Ajay and Urvi Piramal, 2004

The diversified Piramal Group, inherited by Ajay Piramal after the death of elder brother Ashok in 1984 was a motley bag of companies in textiles, automobile ancillaries and pharmaceuticals. The family business split in 2004. According to the settlement, Ajay took charge of Nicholas Piramal, a pharma major, and Gujarat Glass, while Urvi Piramal, wife of his late elder brother, got control of Piramal Holdings and the mall chain Crossroads.



3 Succession Gaps Rajan and Anil Nanda, 2003

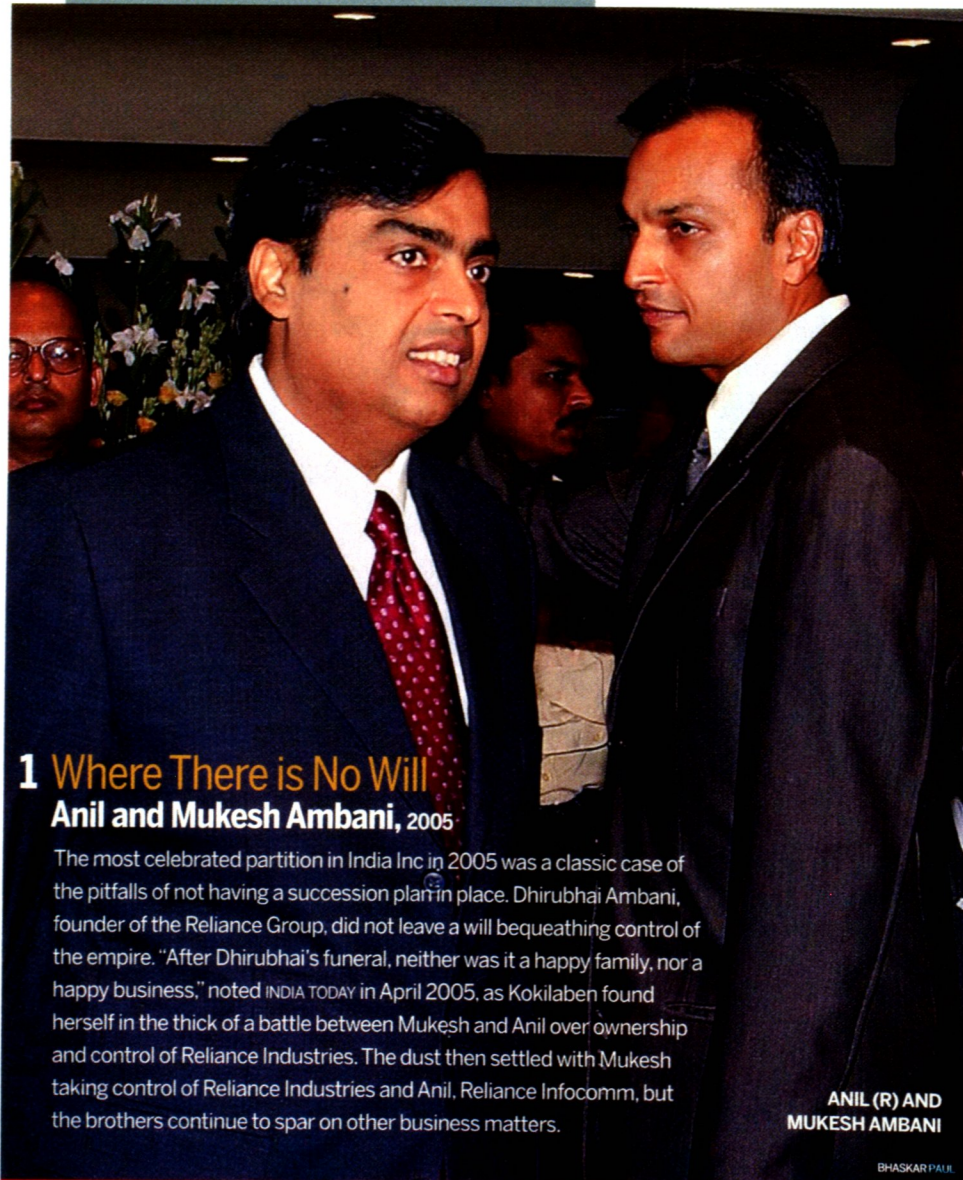
"You can't fight destiny," says Rajan Nanda, Chairman, Escorts Ltd, who has seen many boardroom battles, the most bitter of which was with younger brother Anil Nanda over his move to sell a chunk of Escorts Heart and Research Institute. The group split with Anil quitting as vice-chairman and taking control of Goetze India Ltd.

4 Feuding Arms Kirloskar Family, 2000

The incapability to work together in later generations is a lament of family businesses like Kirloskars. After the death of Shantanurao Kirloskar (SLK), his fortunes were divided between his grandsons—Atul (Kirloskar Oil Engines), Sanjay (Kirloskar Brothers) and Rahul (Kirloskar Pneumatic).

1 Where There is No Will Anil and Mukesh Ambani, 2005

The most celebrated partition in India Inc in 2005 was a classic case of the pitfalls of not having a succession plan in place. Dhirubhai Ambani, founder of the Reliance Group, did not leave a will bequeathing control of the empire. "After Dhirubhai's funeral, neither was it a happy family, nor a happy business," noted INDIA TODAY in April 2005, as Kokilaben found herself in the thick of a battle between Mukesh and Anil over ownership and control of Reliance Industries. The dust then settled with Mukesh taking control of Reliance Industries and Anil, Reliance Infocomm, but the brothers continue to spar on other business matters.



ANIL (R) AND
MUKESH AMBANI

BHASKAR PAUL